HHH-S-666c
April 8, 1963

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. HHH-S-00666b (AGR-AMS)
August 8, 1961 and
Fed. Spec. HHH-S-666a
November 1, 1946

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

SQUASH, FRESH

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Types. Squash shall be of the following types as specified:

(*a*) Summer type; including all varieties and strains which are picked in immature stages of development and eaten without removal of seeds and seed cavity tissue, such as yellow crookneck, yellow straightneck, scallop (patty pan, cymling), zucchini, cocozelle etc., each including one or more varieties (see 6.1).

(*b*) Fall and Winter type; including all varieties and strains customarily marketed for fall and winter consumption, such as Hubbard, Turban, Banana, Boston Marrow, Delicious, Table Queen (Acorn, Demoines) Butternut etc. (see 6.1).

1.2 Size. Size of summer type squash shall be specified in inches and quarter inches as minimum and/or maximum diameter, or minimum and/or maximum length, or both. Size of fall and winter type squash shall be specified as minimum weight or range of weight (see 6.1).

1.3 Grades. Squash shall be of the following grades as specified (see 6.1).

Summer type No. 1 (see 3.2.1)
Summer type No. 2 (see 3.2.2)
Fall or Winter type No. 1 (see 3.2.3)
Fall or Winter type No. 2 (see 3.2.4)

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification.

Federal Specification:

PPP-F-685—Fresh Fruits and Vegetables, Packaging, Packing and Marking Of.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federel Specifications, Standards and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas

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City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, and Auburn, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

2.2 **Other publications.** The following documents form a part of this specification. Unless otherwise indicated, the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

Governmental:

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement.

(Copies of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement may be obtained upon application, accompanied by money order, coupon, or cash to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D.C. Prices may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.)

United States Standards for Summer Squash.

United States Standards for Fall and Winter Type Squash.

(Single copies of the United States Standards for Summer Squash and United States Standards for Fall and Winter Type Squash may be obtained without charge from the U. S. Department of Agriculture, Washington 25, D. C.)

Nongovernmental:

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists.

(Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists is published by the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists, P. O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington 4, D. C.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 **Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act.** All deliveries shall comply in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.2 **Description of grades.** Unless otherwise specified, the interpretation of requirements (descriptive terms) contained in 3.2.1, 3.2.2, 3.2.3, and 3.2.4 shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Summer Squash or the United States Standards for Fall and Winter Type Squash in effect on date of invitation for bids.

3.2.1 *Summer type No.* 1 shall consist of squash of one variety or similar varietal characteristics, with stems or portions of stems attached, which are fairly young and fairly tender, fairly well formed, firm, free from decay and breakdown, and from damage.

3.2.1.1 *Tolerance for lot average.* Not more than 10 percent, by weight, of the squash in any lot may fail to meet the requirements of this grade, but not more than one-half of this tolerance, or 5 percent, shall be allowed for defects causing serious damage, and not more than one-fifth of this amount, or 1 percent, shall be allowed for squash affected by decay or breakdown. Not more than 5 percent, by weight, of squash may be smaller than the minimum size specified and not more than 10 percent, by weight, shall be larger than the maximum specified.

3.2.1.2 *Tolerances for individual containers.* Not more than 15 percent, by weight, of the squash in an individual container may fail to meet the requirements of this grade, but of this tolerance, not more than 10 percent shall be allowed for defects causing serious damage and not more than 2 percent allowed for squash affected by decay or breakdown except that at least one defective squash may be permitted in a container. In an individual container not more than 10 percent, by weight, of the squash may be less than the minimum size specified, and not more than 15 percent, by

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weight, may be larger than the maximum size specified except that at least one off size squash may be permitted in a container.

3.2.2 *Summer type No.* 2 consists of squash of one variety or of similar varietal characteristics, which are firm, not old and tough, free from decay and breakdown, and free from damage caused by freezing, and from serious damage. *Tolerances*: Same as for Summer type No. 1, except that there is no special tolerance for serious defects.

3.2.3 *Fall and Winter type No.* 1. Consists of squash of one variety which are well matured, not broken or cracked, and which are free from soft rot or wet breakdown, and from damage caused by scars, dry rot, freezing, dirt, disease, insects, mechanical or other means.

3.2.3.1 *Tolerances for lot average.* Not more than a total of 10 percent, by weight, of the squash in any lot may fail to meet the requirements of this grade, including not more than 2 percent for squash which are affected by soft rot or wet breakdown, or are seriously damaged by dry rot. In addition, not more than 5 percent, by weight, of any lot may consist of squash smaller than any minimum weight specified, and not more than 15 percent, by weight, of any lot may consist of squash larger than any maximum weight specified.

3.2.3.2 *Tolerances for individual containers.* Not more than 15 percent, by weight, of the squash in an individual container may fail to meet the requirements of this grade, except that, if the container has 15 squash or less, it may contain not more than 20 percent, by weight, or two squash (whichever is greater), which fail to meet the requirements of this grade, but of this tolerance, not more than 4 percent, or one squash (whichever is greater) may be affected by soft rot or wet breakdown or may be seriously damaged by dry rot. In an individual container not more than 10 percent, by weight, of squash or one squash (whichever is greater) may be smaller than the minimum weight specified, and not more than 22.5 percent, by weight, larger than the maximum weight specified, except that 30 percent, by weight, of squash or two squash (whichever is greater) may be larger than the maximum weight specified when packaged in units of 15 squash or less.

3.2.4 *Fall and Winter type No.* 2 consists of squash of similar varietal characteristics which are at least fairly well matured, not broken or cracked, and which are free from soft rot or wet breakdown, and from serious damage. *Tolerances*: Same as for Fall and Winter type No. 1.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling. Samples of squash offered under this specification may be selected by the Government inspector, examined, and tested at any time to determine if it is in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 *General.* Inspection shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative, at the time and place designated by the procuring agency. It may be made at the packing house, both during and after packing, at any suitable point in transit and/or after delivery to the point of destination. If inspection is made during the time of packing, the passing as satisfactory of any detail of packing or materials shall not relieve the contractor of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

4.2.2 *Final inspection.* Unless otherwise specified, final inspection shall be made after delivery to the point of destination (see 6.3 and 6.4).

4.2.3 *USDA certificate of quality and condition.* When specified by the procuring

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agency the contractor shall furnish a U. S. Department of Agriculture, Federal or Federal-State certificate of quality and condition as outlined in procurement documents.

4.2.4 *Responsibility for inspection.* The supplier is responsible for meeting all the provisions of the specification prior to submission of supplies to the Government for acceptance. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier is required to furnish an official inspection certificate issued by a Federal agency certifying that the grade of the product supplied is as required by the contract or order.

4.2.4.1 Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be complete and made available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 *Chemical analyses.* Unless otherwise specified chemical analyses, if required by the purchaser, shall be made in accordance with the methods of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists in effect on the date of invitation for bids, or in accordance with methods that give equivalent results.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

For civil agency procurement, the definitions and applications of the levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be in accordance with 5.1.1 or 5.1.2, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 *Level A (military export).* The product shall be packaged in accordance with PPP-F-685.

5.1.2 *Level C.* Unless otherwise specified, commercial packaging is acceptable.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be in accordance with 5.2.1 or 5.2.2, as specified.

5.2.1 *Level A (military export).* The product shall be packed in accordance with PPP-F-685.

5.2.2 *Level C.* Unless otherwise specified, squash shall be packed in commercial containers which shall be clean, sound, well filled, securely closed or covered and so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common carriers for safe transportation to point of destination specified in shipping instructions, at lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Each container shall be packed so that the squash on the shown face shall be reasonably representative in size, color, and quality of the contents of the container; each container shall be well filled but the contents shall not show excessive or unnecessary bruising because of overfilled packages. Incident to packing, as herein defined, not more than 5 percent of the units may fail to meet the requirements: Provided, that no individual requirement shall be deliberately disregarded.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.*

5.3.1.1 *Labeling.* Any commercial labeling or additional labeling as specified, that complies with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, and regulations promulgated thereunder is acceptable.

5.3.1.2 *Marking for shipment.* Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of Fed. Std. No. 123 and such other information as specified by individual agencies.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.* Labeling and marking shall be in accordance with PPP-F-685.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Type of squash required (see 1.1).
(*b*) Size of squash required (see 1.2).
(*c*) Grade of squash required (see 1.3).
(*d*) USDA certificate of quality and condition, if required (see 4.2.3).
(*e*) Applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.2 If samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.3 Contractor's inspection. The contractor should be required to assure that the product conforms with the specification prior to submission to the Government for final inspection.

6.4 Destination inspection. When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

6.5 Transportation description. Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Types, a and b
Squash.
Carload minimum weight 20,000 pounds.

Motor:

Type a
Summer squash.
Motor volume minimum weight 20,000 pounds.

Type b
Winter squash.
Motor volume minimum weight 24,000 pounds.

Notice. When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications or other data, is not to be regarded by implication, or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Army—GL

Navy—S&A

Air Force—MAA

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity *(as indicated on reverse hereof)*.

SPECIFICATION

ORGANIZATION *(Of submitter)*	CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO.	QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED	DOLLAR AMOUNT
		$

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES.

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)*	DATE

DD FORM 1426 11, APR 63

REPLACES NAVSHIPS FORM 4863, WHICH IS OBSOLETE

PLATE NO. 15419

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